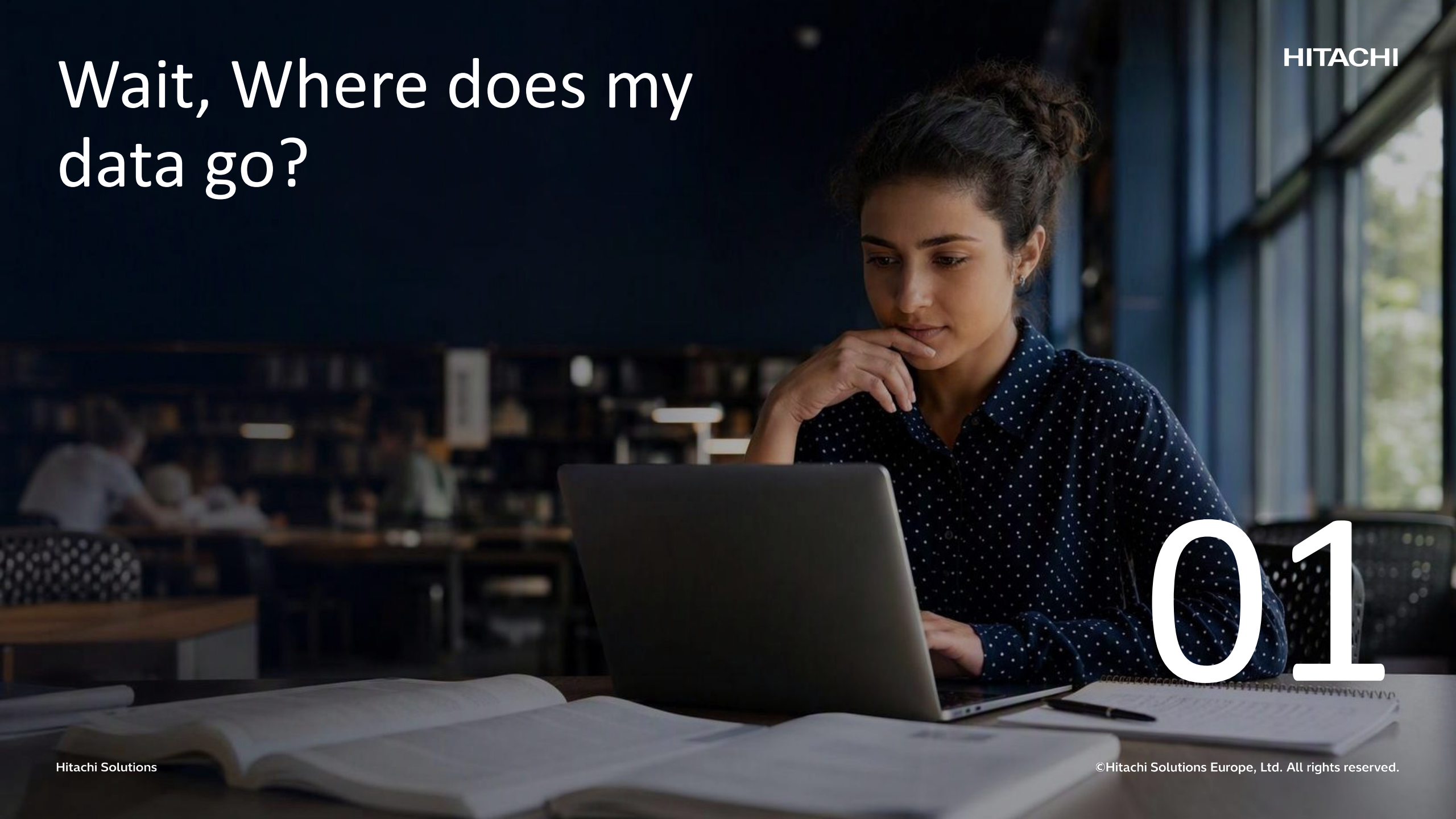
Wait, Where does my data go?



01

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3 burning questions you raised most:

Which Copilot is which?
What happens to your data? How far you can trust it?

01

The 3 different types of Copilot licenses

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Free Copilot

This is the Copilot people see today in Teams, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook or on the web. Microsoft is actively pushing it everywhere, so many users have access even without realizing it.

It **doesn't see your emails, meetings or files.**

Copilot M365

This is the enterprise license provided by the company. It's embedded across Microsoft 365 and works inside the organization's secure environment.

It understands context: your meetings, emails, chats, documents, calendars and SharePoint content, always respecting access rights.

Copilot Studio

It is the tool used to create, customize, and extend Copilots. It's not for everyday usage, but for teams who want Copilot to reflect specific processes or knowledge.

You can use it for: **building internal Copilots** for HR, IT, finance, onboarding, support, or communities. Connecting Copilot to internal data sources, workflows, and business rules.

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Where to find Copilot?

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Copilot can be accessed in a few places



Desktop /Browser application

Search for ‘Copilot’ or ‘M365 Copilot’ on your devices search bar.



Microsoft Edge web browser feature

The Copilot web browser feature integrates AI capabilities directly into your browsing experience



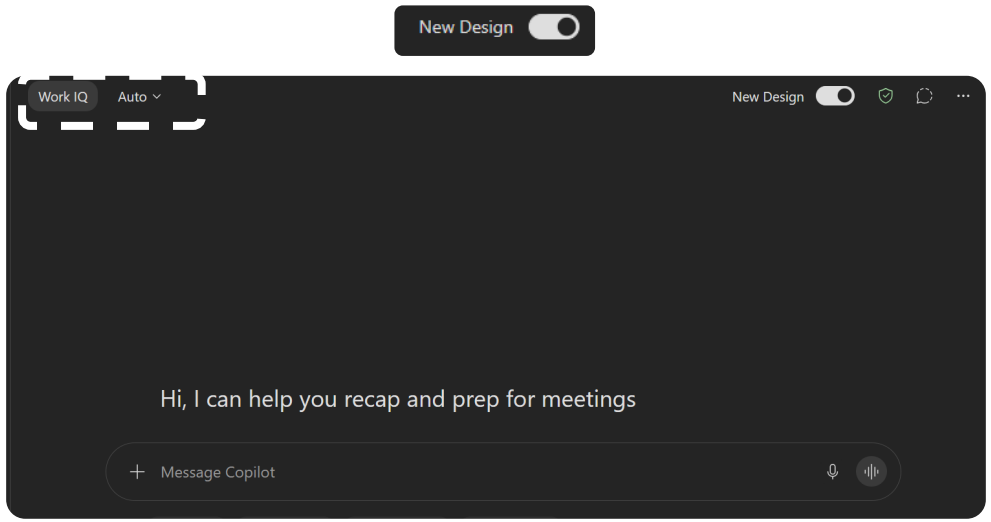
Microsoft Office apps extension

Microsoft Copilot is integrated into several Microsoft 365 applications to enhance productivity and streamline tasks

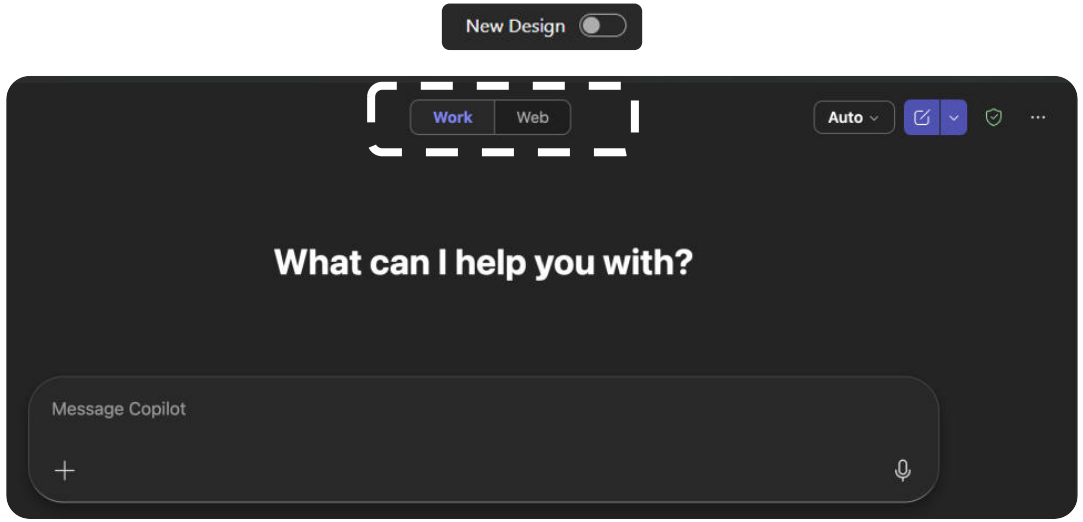
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What Copilot version are you using? Let’s find out!

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or



Work/Work IQ vs Web = two different brains

Work mode uses internal documents:

- Grounded in your organisation's content
- Pulls from your files, emails, chats and meetings
- Answers stay inside your tenant. Data stays protected
- Turn it on for anything work-related. This is the default

Web mode uses internet data:

- General, public web knowledge only
- No grounding to your organisation's content
- Fine for general questions and quick lookups
- Don't paste confidential Hitachi Rail material here

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A few myths vs reality about Copilot

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Is it safe?

MYTH

It’s risky and works like public AI tools.

REALITY

Copilot runs in your secure environment and follows company policies. The risk comes from what you paste and what you send without reviewing.



Is it reliable?

MYTH

It knows everything and is always right.

REALITY

It only sees what you can access, and can sound confident yet be wrong, so verify.



Is it for me?

MYTH

It’s only for tech experts with perfect prompts.

REALITY

Most value comes from simple daily tasks; clear intent beats clever wording.

Copilot amplifies your thinking — it doesn’t replace it.

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Why Copilot sometimes surprises you

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How Copilot uses data

Inherits your data quality

Work Copilot reflects the state of your internal documentation.
Outdated, duplicated or fragmented files lead to weaker outputs.

Surfaces permission gaps

Wrong access settings can let it reveal restricted documents.

How Copilot thinks

Hallucinations happen when data is unclear or missing

They’re not a bug, they’re a sign of weak inputs or ambiguous prompts.

Won’t push back unless asked

It tends to agree; tell it to challenge or stress-test your ideas.

Why results vary

Adapts to each app

It already knows the app you’re in (e.g. Teams, Word, Outlook) – prompt for the missing piece.

Strongest in key languages

English leads, then French, German, Spanish, Italian, Japanese, Portuguese.

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Every prompt has a footprint. How do we make it worthwhile?

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Responsible prompting is not about avoiding AI. It is about using the right level of AI for the research value required.

THE CHALLENGE

AI use consumes energy and water.

There is no single footprint for a prompt. Impact varies by model, task, input, output and underlying infrastructure.

THE QUESTION

Is this the right use of AI?

Am I using an appropriate tool and asking for the research value I actually need?

THE THINKING

Make every interaction purposeful

- Avoid unnecessary AI use
- Reduce repetition and excessive outputs
- Verify the research value produced
- Record significant AI use where relevant
- Follow university, ethics and disclosure requirements

Responsible prompting means achieving the required research value with the minimum appropriate computation.

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Using Copilot with research material

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Paula
PhD researcher

Paula is preparing for a supervisor meeting. She has two open-access papers she may share and her own non-sensitive research notes.

She asks Copilot to:

- “Summarise this paper’s methods and findings in 5 bullets.”
- “Compare the methods in these two papers. Cite the relevant sections.”
- “List the limitations the authors report. Flag any missing information.”
- “Draft a supervisor update using only my progress notes.”



Checks before sharing

- Use your university-approved Copilot account
- Share only material your university permits
- Check consent, ethics and confidentiality requirements

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Responsible use of Copilot in research

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Paula
PhD researcher

Paula now wants to work with participant interviews. Check permissions and ethics approval before sharing any data.

Research guardrails

- Keep identifiable participant data out unless explicitly approved
- Verify every reference and claim against its source
- Keep ownership of your analysis and conclusions



Prompts to avoid

Keep the task within the approved purpose.

- Avoid: “Identify the participants from these interview details.”
- Avoid: “Invent references to support my hypothesis.”

You remain accountable for your research. Check outputs and follow university and publisher AI disclosure rules.

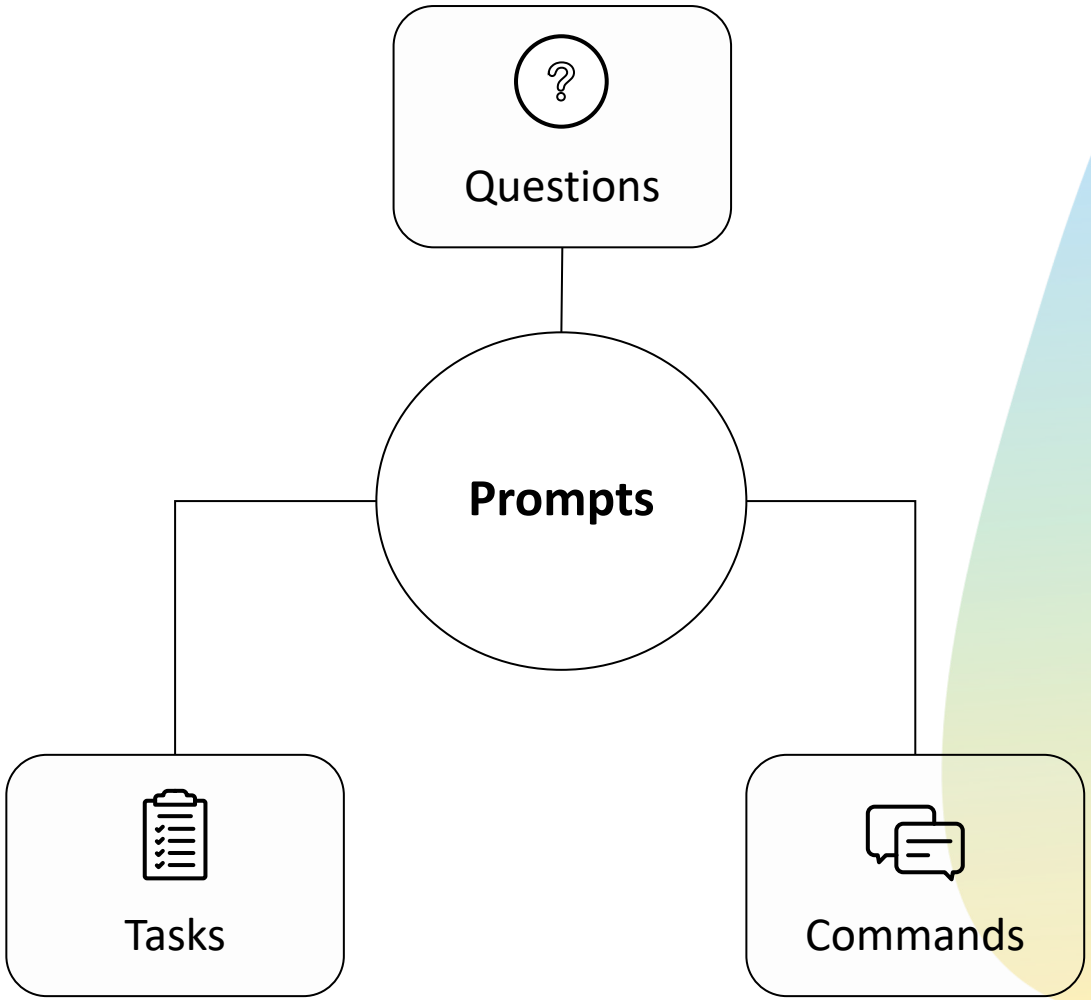
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Effective prompting



03

What is a prompt?



A prompt is a clear instruction or question you give to Copilot to guide its response.

It can be:

- A **task** (e.g., “Summarise this report”)
- A **question** (e.g., “What are the key trends in this data?”)
- A **command** (e.g., “Draft an email to the team”)

Think of a prompt as how you “talk” to Copilot to get the help you need - just like giving directions to a helpful assistant.

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GCSE prompt framework

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WHAT Do I want?	**WHY** Do I need it?	**WHERE** To look?	**HOW** Do I need it?
			
GOAL	**C**ONTEXT	**S**OURCE	**E**XPECTATIONS
What response or output do you want from Copilot?	Why do you need it and who is involved?	Which information sources should Copilot use?	How should Copilot respond to meet your expectations?

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Include the right prompt ingredients

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Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

Draft a clear, executive-ready first pass of monthly results commentary, summarising key financial movements and variances for leadership review. This supports senior stakeholders who need insight and narrative, not raw data. The commentary should aid decision-making and highlight what matters most this month. Use the current month's financial results, prior-month commentary, and any relevant assumptions or policies. Keep it concise, factual, and plain English. Highlight drivers, risks, and actions. Flag any uncertainty or data gaps. .

How to respond to best meet your expectations

Expectations

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

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Remember this formula

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Act as a [Context].
Help me [Goal].
Use [Source].
Give me the result as [Expectations].

Simple tip: Ask Copilot to remind you of this formula when prompting!

"Remember that whenever my prompt is vague, remind me to use the GCSE framework: Goal, Context, Sources, Expectations.."

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Keep iterating

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Good

Help me prepare for a contract review meeting by creating a list of the most important clauses.

Better

I'm a Contract Manager at Hitachi Rail who needs to prepare for a quaterly review meeting with a supplier.
Please create a list of the most important clauses and explain why they should be discussed, so the team can focus on key topics and make informed decisions in the meeting.

Best

I'm a Contract Manager at Hitachi Rail who needs to preparefor a quaterly review meeting with a supplier. Please review the attached contract [file], recent correspondence and the previous meeting and give me a summary of the most important clauses, risks and why they should be discussed, so that I can identify the key topics of discussion for the team to highlight in the meeting.

Goal **Context** **Source** **Expectations**

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Ask yourself these questions when prompting

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Use Copilot across your entire workflow



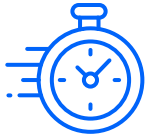
Why am I using this prompt?

What is the context for the ask?



What will I do with the output of the prompt?

Am I going to send it onto someone else? Does it need to be in a different format?



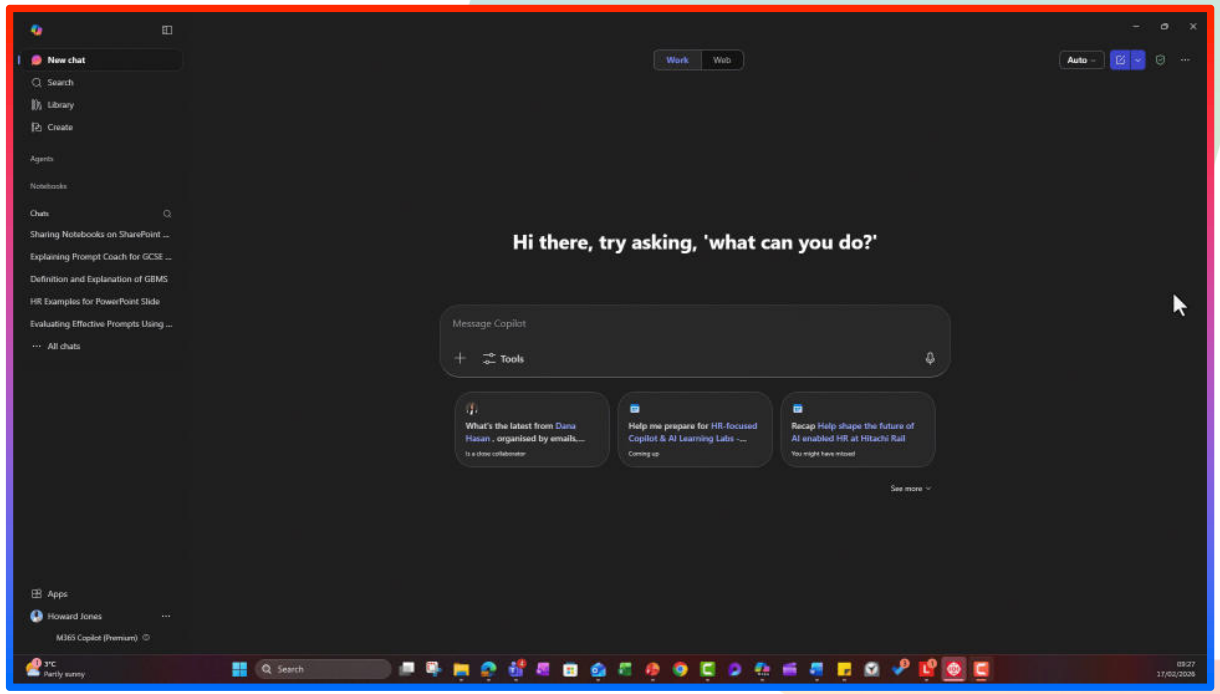
Can I extend Copilot's remit to save more time?

Can I ask Copilot to do a bigger task to automate more work?

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Use the Prompt Coach agent

Prompt Coach functions as a mentor within the workflow – it doesn't provide direct solutions but guides you to enhance your communication and documentation by applying the structured G-C-S-E type model commonly.



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Exercise:



04

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Hands on Copilot Exercise

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Designing an effective prompt for a real finance use case

1	2	3	4
Acknowledge the use case	**Design the prompt using GCSE structure**	**Test it in Copilot**	**Sense check the result**
What specific situation requires us to utilise Copilot?	Which elements of the scenario am I allowed to share with Copilot?	What response can I expect from Copilot when using this prompt?	How can I enhance this information to make it more effective? Is there a way I can improve it?
Prepare	**Frame and Execute**		**Validate**

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Include the right prompt ingredients

HITACHI

Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

I am at the early stage of developing a postgraduate research project. Help me turn my broad interest in how generative AI is changing the way university students learn into a small number of credible research directions that I could investigate.

How to respond to best meet your expectations

Expectations

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

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Include the right prompt ingredients

HITACHI

Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

I am interested in the relationship between generative AI, student learning behaviours and independent learning in higher education. I haven't yet decided on a precise research question, methodology or theoretical framework. I want to explore the topic before narrowing it down, rather than jumping immediately to a finished research question. Treat me as the researcher. Your role is to help me explore and challenge my thinking, not to make the research decisions for me.

How to respond to best meet your expectations

Expectations

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

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Include the right prompt ingredients

HITACHI

Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

For this initial exploration, use the information I have provided above and your general knowledge to help me map the topic.

Clearly distinguish between:

- ideas or hypotheses that need testing;
- established concepts or bodies of research that may be relevant;
- claims for which I should seek supporting academic evidence.

Do not invent citations or references. Where literature would be useful, suggest search concepts and keywords I could investigate through my university's academic databases rather than presenting unverified references as evidence.

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

How to respond to best meet your expectations

Expectations

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Include the right prompt ingredients

HITACHI

Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

Structure your response in five parts:

1. Identify 5 possible research directions within this broad topic.
2. For each, explain why it could be interesting to investigate and what remains uncertain.
3. Suggest 2 possible research questions for each direction.
4. Identify useful keywords and search terms that could help me begin exploring the academic literature.
5. Finish by asking me 5 challenging questions, one at a time, to help me decide which direction best fits my interests, research context and intended contribution.

Do not select the “best” topic for me. Help me make that judgement myself.

How to respond to best meet your expectations

Expectations

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

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Include the right prompt ingredients

HITACHI

Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

Expectations

How to respond to best meet your expectations

I am at the early stage of developing a postgraduate research project. Help me turn my broad interest in how generative AI is changing the way university students learn into a small number of credible research directions that I could investigate. I am interested in the relationship between generative AI, student learning behaviours and independent learning in higher education. I haven't yet decided on a precise research question, methodology or theoretical framework. I want to explore the topic before narrowing it down, rather than jumping immediately to a finished research question. Treat me as the researcher. Your role is to help me explore and challenge my thinking, not to make the research decisions for me. For this initial exploration, use the information I have provided above and your general knowledge to help me map the topic. Clearly distinguish between, 1. ideas or hypotheses that need testing, 2. established concepts or bodies of research that may be relevant, & 3. claims for which I should seek supporting academic evidence. Do not invent citations or references. Where literature would be useful, suggest search concepts and keywords I could investigate through my university's academic databases rather than presenting unverified references as evidence. Structure your response in five parts: 1. Identify 5 possible research directions within this broad topic.2. For each, explain why it could be interesting to investigate and what remains uncertain. 3. Suggest 2 possible research questions for each direction. 4. Identify useful keywords and search terms that could help me begin exploring the academic literature. 5. Finish by asking me 5 challenging questions, one at a time, to help me decide which direction best fits my interests, research context and intended contribution. Do not select the “best” topic for me. Help me make that judgement myself.

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Your Prompt

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Consider and highlight the below in your Prompts

Goal

What response do you want?

Context

Why?

Expectations

How to respond to best meet your expectations

Source

Where can you find everything you need?

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Capture your Goals

HITACHI

What response do you want?

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Capture your Context

HITACHI

How to respond to best meet your expectations

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Capture your Expectations

HITACHI

What response do you want?

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Capture your Source

Where can you find everything, you need?

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Challenge the answer, improve the prompt

Each group shares its question, prompt and output, and the wider group tests how good the answer really is.

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Name _____ **Group** _____ **Question tested** _____

What did it get right?

Test the answer back against the evidence in the pack.

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

What did it miss?

Look for the numbers, risks or caveats it skipped over.

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

What did it infer rather than evidence?

Separate what the pack states from what the model assumed.

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

Refine and run it again

Sharpen the prompt with those follow-ups and compare the second answer.

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

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